

Lo, how a Rose e'er blooming

Text: v.1-2 anonymous, 1599; v.3 Friedrich Layritz, 1599
tr. v.1-2 Theodore Baker, 1894; v.3 Harriet Spaeth, 1875; alt.
ES IST EIN ROS' 76.76.676

Music: Michael Praetorius, 1609

The musical score is written for a single voice part on a treble clef staff with a key signature of two flats (B-flat and E-flat). The melody is simple and hymn-like, with a final double bar line at the end of the fourth line. The lyrics are arranged in three systems, with the first system having three numbered verses. The text is printed below the staff, with hyphens indicating syllables that span across two notes.

1 Lo, how a Rose e'er bloom - ing from ten - der stem has sprung!
2 I - sa - iah 'twas fore - told it, the Rose I have in mind.
3 Flow - er, whose fra-grance ten - der with sweet-ness fills the air,
Of Jes - se's lin - eage com - ing as saints of old have sung.
With Ma - ry we be - hold it, the vir - gin moth - er kind.
dis - pel in glo - rious splen - dor the dark-ness ev - 'ry-where.
It came a flow'r - et bright, a - mid the
To show God's love a - right, she bore to
Hu - man, yet ver - y God, from sin and
cold of win - ter, when half - spent was the night.
us a Sav - ior, when half - spent was the night.
death he saves us, and light - ens ev - 'ry load.